

Promethazine HCL-Fresenius 50 mg/2 ml Injection

Description

A clear and colourless to slight straw coloured sterile solution in glass amber ampoules.

Composition

Each ml ampoule contains 25 mg of Promethazine Hydrochloride.

Mode of Action

Promethazine is histamine H₁ receptor antagonists competing reversibly with histamine for H₁ receptor sites on effector cells. They suppress symptoms caused by histamine release. Antihistamines have anticholinergic properties and have a drying effect on the nasal mucosa.

Promethazine is a phenothiazine histamine antagonist. Phenothiazine derivatives are thought to cause indirect reduction of stimuli to the brain stem reticular activating system. They have antiemetic and sedative properties. Promethazine also has local anaesthetic properties.

Summary of Pharmacodynamics and Pharmacokinetics

After injection, Promethazine hydrochloride is distributed widely in the body. It enters the brain and crosses the placenta. Promethazine is slowly excreted via urine and bile.

Following intravenous injection Promethazine hydrochloride onset of action of about 3 to 5 minutes. Following intramuscular injection has an onset of action of about 20 minutes.

Indications

Promethazine is indicated in the treatment of allergic reactions such as uncomplicated allergic conditions of the immediate type, eg, pruritus, urticaria and angioedema, when oral therapy is impossible or contraindicated. Treatment and prevention of vomiting including:

- motion sickness
 - drug induced nausea
 - prevention and control of nausea and vomiting associated with certain types of anaesthesia and surgery, such as procedures with a high incidence of postoperative vomiting (eg, gynaecological surgery, strabismus or middle ear surgery, and electroconvulsive therapy); in patients with a past history of motion sickness or postoperative vomiting; and in patients in whom avoidance of vomiting is crucial (eg, neurosurgery and eye surgery).
- Promethazine has sedative effects and it is also used in preoperative, postoperative and obstetric (during labour) sedation.

Side Effects/Adverse Reaction

Side effects of Promethazine are:

CENTRAL NERVOUS SYSTEM

Sedation, dizziness, fatigue, lassitude, incoordination, tremors, confusion, blurred vision, diplopia, tinnitus, euphoria, nervousness, tingling and weakness of the hands, irritability, nightmares, insomnia, hallucinations, convulsions and extrapyramidal effects.

ANTI-CHOLINERGIC EFFECTS

Dryness of the mouth and respiratory passages, thickening of mucous, cough, increased sweating, urinary retention or frequency and dysuria. Headache, tight chest, palpitations, tachycardia and severe hypotension.

GASTRO-INTESTINAL DISTURBANCE

Loss of appetite, nausea, vomiting, epigastric distress and diarrhoea. Reduction in tone and motility of the gastro-intestinal tract, resulting in gastric reflux and constipation.

HYPERSENSITIVITY REACTIONS

Allergic dermatitis, drug fever, photosensitization and jaundice.

BLOOD DISORDERS

Aggranulocytosis, haemolytic anaemia, leucopenia, thrombocytopenia.

Warning/Precautions

Promethazine may cause drowsiness and impaired concentration, which may be aggravated by simultaneous intake of alcohol or other central nervous system depressant agents e.g. sedatives and tranquillisers. Patients undergoing treatment with promethazine should not take charge of vehicles or other means of transport, or machinery, or perform potentially dangerous tasks, where loss of attention may lead to accidents. Caution should be used when the following medical conditions exist: prostatic hypertrophy, narrow angle glaucoma, emphysema or chronic bronchitis and porphyria. Elderly patients are especially susceptible to dizziness, sedation, confusion, hypotension and anticholinergic effects such as dry mouth and urinary retention.

Use is not recommended in children under 2 years of age except on the advice of a doctor. Should be used with care in dehydrated or acutely ill children, as these patients have an increased incidence of dystonias. Use with care in patients with epilepsy, jaundice, parkinsonism, diabetes mellitus, hypothyroidism and myasthenia gravis. Phenothiazines should not be used in patients with pre-existing central nervous system depression, bone marrow depression, liver disorders, phaeochromocytoma or Reye's Syndrome. Promethazine should not be given by subcutaneous injection.

Caution should be used when the following medical conditions exist: severe cardiovascular disorders, epilepsy and during an acute attack of asthma. Safety in pregnancy has not been established. Phenothiazine derivatives have been reported to cause jaundice and extrapyramidal symptoms in infants whose mothers received these agents during pregnancy.

When used in breastfeeding phenothiazine derivatives may cause drowsiness or excitement and/or irritability in infants.

WARNING

This preparation contains Sodium metabisulphite that may cause serious allergic type reactions in certain susceptible patients. Do not use if known to be hypersensitive to bisulphites.

This product contains Promethazine Hydrochloride. It should not be used in pediatric patients less than 2 years of age because of the potential for fatal respiratory depression.

Contraindication

Promethazine Hydrochloride is contra-indicated in patients with a hypersensitivity to Promethazine and any of the ingredients. Promethazine is contra-indicated during acute attacks of asthma and in comatose patients. Not for use in children under 1 year of age. The use of promethazine may be associated with the sudden infant death syndrome (SIDS).

Recommended Dose and Directions for Use

Promethazine HCL-Fresenius injections administered by intramuscular or intravenous injection.

FOR USE ALLERGIC CONDITIONS

Usual adult and adolescent dose: 25 mg intramuscular or intravenous. May be repeated within 2 hours if required.
Children 2 years and older: Intramuscularly - 0.125 mg/kg body weight every 4 to 6 hours OR 0.5 mg/kg bodyweight at bedtime as needed OR 6.25 - 12.5 mg three times a day as needed OR 25 mg at bedtime as needed.

FOR USE ANTI EMETIC THERAPY

Usual adult and adolescent dose: 25 mg initially and then 10 - 25 mg every 4 - 6 hours as needed.
Children: 0.25 - 0.5 mg/kg every 4 to 6 hours as needed OR 10 - 25 mg every 4 to 6 hours as needed.

FOR USE MOTION SICKNESS

Usual adult and adolescent dose: 25 mg twice a day as needed.
Children: 0.5 mg/kg every 12 hours as needed OR 10 - 25 mg twice a day as needed.

FOR USE SEDATIVE/HYPNOTIC USE

Usual adult and adolescent dose: 25 - 50 mg at night, or pre- or post surgically. Children: 0.5 - 1.0 mg/kg OR 10 - 25 mg as needed.
Promethazine hydrochloride may be given by slow intravenous injection or injected into the tubing of a freely running infusion in a concentration of not more than 25 mg/ml, although it is usually diluted to 2.5 mg/ml. The rate of infusion should not exceed 25 mg per minute.

Incompatibilities

Promethazine should not be combined with other aqueous solutions of medications except with water for injection, Dextrose 5 %, Dextrose 10 %, Sodium chloride 0.45 % and Sodium chloride 0.9 %. The injection should be freshly prepared and unused portions should be discarded.

Use In Pregnancy and Lactation

Pregnancy category C. Promethazine Injection should not be used in pregnancy unless the physician considers it essential. Adequate and well-controlled studies in humans have not been done. However, Promethazine taken within 2 weeks prior to delivery may inhibit platelet aggregation in the newborn.

Studies in rats with doses 2.1 to 4.2 times the maximum recommended human daily dose have not shown that Promethazine causes adverse effects on fetal development.

Available evidence suggests that the amount excreted in milk is insignificant. However, there are risks of neonatal irritability and excitement.

Interaction With Other Medicaments/Drug Interactions

All sedatives and alcohol potentiate the central nervous system depressant effects of the antihistamines. Tricyclic antidepressants or maprotiline potentiate anticholinergic effects if taken with antihistamines. Monoamine oxidase inhibitors will potentiate both the drowsiness effect and the anticholinergic effects if taken with antihistamines. Concurrent use is not recommended. Anticholinergics or drugs with anticholinergic activity will be potentiated if used concurrently with antihistamines. Positive skin tests may be suppressed by antihistamines; therefore treatment with antihistamines should be stopped several days before the test. The alpha adrenergic effect of adrenaline may be blocked possibly resulting in severe hypotension and tachycardia. Medications tending to cause extrapyramidal reactions may be potentiated by phenothiazines and the extrapyramidal effects aggravated. The antiparkinsonian effects of levodopa may be inhibited.

Intravenous injections of promethazine hydrochloride must be given slowly and extreme care must be taken to avoid perivascular extravasation or inadvertent intra arterial injection, due to the risk of severe chemical irritation. Venous thrombosis has been reported at the site of intravenous injection and arteriospasm and gangrene may follow inadvertent intra-arterial injection.

Symptoms and Treatment of Overdose

Symptoms of overdose include drowsiness or paradoxical excitement, ataxia, tremors, ateliosis, hallucinations and convulsions. Fixed dilated pupils with a flushed face, sinus tachycardia, dyspnoea, urinary retention, dry mouth and fever. Terminally there may be deepening coma and cardiorespiratory collapse.

Central excitatory effects constitute the greatest danger, particularly in children who are more likely to exhibit central nervous system stimulation. Adults more frequently exhibit central nervous system depression and the aged are particularly prone to experience hypotension.

Treatment of overdose is the stomach should be emptied by emesis or lavage. There is no specific antidote and treatment is symptomatic and supportive. Treatment of extrapyramidal reactions may be necessary with diphenhydramine or barbiturates.

Presentation

This injection is available in 2 ml ampoules
10 ampoules are packed into one outer carton.

Storage Condition

Protect from light and store below 30 °Celsius. Keep out of reach of children.

Shelf Life

The injections can be used within 60 months from the date of manufacture if kept as recommended.

Manufactured by

Fresenius Kabi Manufacturing SA (Pty) Ltd.
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